

Mobility on a budget

Notebooks these days are a lot more affordable than you'd think. And thirty-five grand can buy you a lot more notebook than it did a couple of years ago

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Notebooks have long since become everyday commodities for most of us. From those needing connectivity on the go, to those looking for entertainment, notebooks are both necessities and status symbols in equal measure, and not mutually exclusive! Product lines have segregated – there are notebooks that get the job done, and then there are those that win beauty awards (while getting the same job done). However, just because you spent 50,000 bucks less than your neighbour on a notebook, doesn't mean you deserve less, does it? Manufacturers have recognised this fact, and we were pleasantly surprised to see a bunch of rather smart looking notebooks trotting into this comparison.

What also surprised us were the specifications on these notebooks. Gone are the days when a dual core processor was exclusively reserved for notebooks costing more than half a lakh. All of the notebooks tested here are overkills for basic office work – mails, documents and spreadsheets. In fact some of these notebooks would give three-year old desktops a fair run for their money. Processing power, graphics

Acer Timeline 4820T was awarded the Best Buy and Best Performer

hardware, lots of RAM, reasonable storage space, and attractive looks – these notebooks seem to have it all, and as consumers, we cannot complain.

However, when looking at notebooks in these price segments, it becomes even more important to study each feature, and more importantly, how well it is implemented. Obviously, manufacturers

have to cost cut somewhere, and if this is not done with components, then it is surely done with materials used, features and the usability of the same. We're used to seeing sub-standard displays, poor trackpads, mediocre keypads and such in value-oriented notebooks such as these, and as such were on a stricter lookout for any grievances.

Unfortunately for us, we missed out on a few very important brands at the time of going to print. Dell, HCL, Sony and Samsung were unable to arrange to send us notebooks within our set

deadlines, and arrived too late to be included in this comparison.

You can expect reviews of the same on thinkdigit.com, and we'll be uploading a larger comparison sheet with all the notebooks that have been missed. We didn't get any HP notebooks, as they (HP) have a policy of not par-



Acer Aspire 5742G was awarded the Editor's Pick